

Chapter 123-6

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Zhao Xuning used to always be like this.

When Shen Hui was coaxing her, she would push her luck.

But whenever Shen Hui got angry, she would be the one to coax her.

Between them, with this give and take, they could always find the most comfortable balance.

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The past was once again stirred up by that name from Liang Shi's mouth. Zhao Xuning sat wearily in her chair, the chair turned away from the desk, and she raised her arm to cover her eyes.

In the end, did she still have to move forward?

Zhao Xuning let out a soft breath, her heart aching with a twisting pain.

She thought: then she would wish Shen Hui happiness in a world without her.

Having left this jerk behind, Shen Hui would be better off, right?

She would eat properly now, right?

She wouldn't keep getting thinner anymore.

Shen Hui deserved better.

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Liang Shi originally didn't want to interfere in the matters between Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui, but Zhao Xuning had given her too much.

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After leaving Zhao Xuning's office, Liang Shi came to the place the Municipal Public Security Bureau had notified her about.

Gu Xingyue had just woken up, so naturally she couldn't undergo a long interview.

Before Liang Shi arrived, Gu Xingyue had already been interviewed once. She spoke weakly, but her logic was clear as she recounted everything.

Including how Qi Xiangui was killed by Yang Jiani.

That day, Qi Xiangui had a social engagement and came home very late, yet he demanded that Gu Xingyue play the piano for him. Gu Xingyue made an excuse saying she wasn't feeling well—she actually had a slight fever—so she tried to refuse.

Unexpectedly, Qi Xiangui casually grabbed a vase and hurled it at her, "You useless thing, go play for me!"

Gu Xingyue didn't want to, but as a result, Qi Xiangui grabbed her by the back of her neck and dragged her to the piano. Her head even slammed hard against the piano. Seeing this, Yang Jiani stepped forward to intervene.

The drunk Qi Xiangui directly slapped Yang Jiani across the face. Because of the excessive force, Yang Jiani was thrown to the ground entirely. Gu Xingyue went to help her up, while Qi Xiangui cursed: "You damn woman, I feed you well and give you a good life so you can take care of our daughter at home properly. Look at this thing you've raised!"

To Qi Xiangui, she was just a tool for showing off.

Not his daughter, not even a person.

Hearing this, Gu Xingyue glared at him furiously. Her gaze irritated Qi Xiangui, and he swung another slap at her.

Her face immediately turned red, with obvious finger marks on the right side.

Yang Jiani went to protect her. This action infuriated Qi Xiangui even more, so he began punching and kicking both of them.

The strength of an adult male Alpha was something two Omega women couldn't withstand. Especially since Qi Xiangui had been drinking—his fists landing on them felt like huge rocks smashing down, causing dense, throbbing pain everywhere.

And when he kicked, it was with enough force to nearly break Gu Xingyue's ribs.

Unable to bear the pain any longer, Gu Xingyue said: "I'll go play."

With disheveled hair, she sat before the piano, her fingers trembling as they landed on the keys. But she couldn't even play a complete piece.

Qi Xiangui kicked her in the back.

Gu Xingyue snapped, yelling: "To you, playing the piano is no different from fluffing cotton anyway!¹ You can't tell the difference at all!"

There was still blood on her face, making her look fierce.

These words directly enraged Qi Xiangui, as if she had stepped on his tail. He kicked her once more.

Gu Xingyue cried and yelled at the same time: "I just can't play! You don't need to hit Mom anymore—just kill me instead!"

Qi Xiangui's absolute position as head of the household was being challenged. Facing Gu Xingyue's defiant gaze, Qi Xiangui first pinned her to the ground and beat her. But Yang Jiani, fearing she would be beaten to death, immediately rushed over to shield her.

And Gu Xingyue kept howling: "Mom, don't interfere! Just let him kill me! Let me die! He can go to prison! That way you won't have to suffer for the rest of your life!"

Hearing this, Qi Xiangui suddenly said coldly: "Did Yang Jiani fucking teach you this? Fine, so you want to kill us all off and then continue being your Yang family's eldest miss by yourself, is that it?! Dream on!"

Qi Xiangui then viciously beat Yang Jiani.

Gu Xingyue went to protect Yang Jiani again, continuously provoking Qi Xiangui: "If you have the guts, then kill me! I'm not even a person to you anyway! I'm just a tool you use to show off! Kill me then!"

She looked as if she had gone mad, afraid of neither pain nor death—completely different from her usual delicate and weak appearance.

Footnotes:

¹ **Fluffing cotton (彈棉花):** This is a traditional Chinese craft where cotton is beaten/fluffed with a special bow-like tool to make it soft for quilts and bedding. The Chinese word for playing an instrument (彈) is the same as the word for fluffing/beating cotton, so Gu Xingyue is making a bitter joke that to someone as uncultured as Qi Xiangui, the refined art of piano playing might as well be the crude labor of fluffing cotton—he can't appreciate the difference anyway.